PAKISTAN KNOWLEDGE VAULT: UNIQUE & ADVANCED DATA

1. UNESCO World Heritage Sites in Pakistan

Site Name	Year	Significance & Distinct Features
Mohenjo-daro	1980	One of the world's earliest major urban settlements (Indus Valley Civilization). Known for sophisticated civil engineering, baked brick buildings, and advanced wastewater systems.
Taxila	1980	A vast premier archaeological site showing the evolution of urban centers along the ancient Silk Road. It features a blend of Persian, Greek, and Buddhist art/architecture.
Takht-i-Bahi & Sahr-i-Bahlol	1980	A renowned Buddhist monastic complex from the 1st century CE, exceptionally well-preserved on a scenic hilltop in Khyber Pakhtunkhwa.
Fort & Shalamar Gardens, Lahore	1981	Masterpieces of the Mughal golden age. The fort contains breathtaking marble palaces; Shalamar represents peak Persian-style quadripartite paradise gardens.
Historical Monuments at Makli, Thatta	1981	One of the world's largest funerary sites, housing half a million tombs. Features stunning stone carvings and intricate glaze-tile work from the 14th-18th centuries.
Rohtas Fort	1997	An exceptional, massive 16th-century military garrison built by Sher Shah Suri. Strategically engineered with monumental defensive walls and structural traps.

2. Nishan-e-Haider Recipients (Highest Military Gallantry Award)

Recipient Name	Rank / Regiment	Conflict / Year	Key Achievement / Action
Captain Raja Muhammad Sarwar	Captain / Punjab Regiment	Kashmir War (1948)	First recipient; breached strong enemy barbed wire obstacles facing intense machine-gun fire.
Naik Saif Ali Janjua	Naik / Azad Kashmir Regt	Kashmir War (1948)	Awarded Hilal-e-Kashmir (equivalent to Nishan-e-Haider); defended a vital post against overwhelming numbers.
Major Tufail Muhammad	Major / Punjab Regiment	Lakshmipur Border (1958)	Encircled an enemy outpost despite mortal wounds; directed operations until successful capture.
Major Raja Aziz Bhatti	Major / Punjab Regiment	Indo-Pak War (1965)	Held the strategic BRB Canal under non-stop armor artillery shelling for days without sleep.
Pilot Officer Rashid Minhas	Pilot Officer / PAF	Indo-Pak War (1971)	Only PAF recipient; deliberately forced his hijacked trainer jet to crash to prevent defection.
Major Muhammad Akram	Major / Frontier Force	Battle of Hilli (1971)	Blocked an entire enemy brigade's advance across an armored corridor with epic resistance.
Major Shabbir Sharif	Major / Frontier Force	Indo-Pak War (1971)	Captured a strategic bridgehead, swam a river under fire, and knocked out multiple tanks.
Sawar Muhammad Hussain	Sawar / Armoured Corps	Battle of Zafarwal (1971)	Spotted enemy movements on foot and single-handedly guided anti-tank recoilless rifle crews.
Lance Naik Muhammad Mahfuz	Lance Naik / Punjab Regt	Wagah-Attari Sector (1971)	Advanced unarmed toward a firing bunker after his weapon broke, neutralizing the position manually.
Captain Karnal Sher Khan	Captain / Sindh Regt / NLI	Kargil Conflict (1999)	Established highly strategic posts at 18,400 feet; led fierce counter-attacks praised by adversaries.

Havildar Lalak Jan	Havildar / Northern Light Inf.	Kargil Conflict (1999)	Refused medical evacuation despite severe injuries, maintaining continuous machine gun fire.

3. Megaprojects, Technology & Infrastructure

Category / Project	Key Strategic details & Unique Engineering facts
Karakoram Highway (KKH)	Often termed the '8th Wonder of the World'. Cuts through the collision zone of the Eurasian and Indian tectonic plates, linking Pakistan to China at Khunjerab Pass (4,693m)—the world's highest paved international border crossing.
Gawadar Deep Water Port	The crown jewel of CPEC. It is the world's largest deep-sea warm-water port, built at a strategic apex at the mouth of the Persian Gulf, providing landlocked Central Asia an direct energy pipeline route.
SUPARCO & Space Tech	Space & Upper Atmosphere Research Commission. Established in 1961 by Nobel laureate Dr. Abdus Salam. Pakistan was the 1st South Asian country to launch a sounding rocket (Rehbar-I, 1962).
Khewra Salt Mine	The world's 2nd largest salt mine, discovered historically by Alexander the Great's army horse-licks in 326 BC. Produces world-famous pink Himalayan salt via an underground room-and-pillar mining maze.